THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 10: **Indian Architecture** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which is the best example of adaptation to climate? 1

(a) Thick walls and courtyards in Rajasthan **(b)** glass towers
(c) domes in snow **(d)** stilts in desert

2. Which cultural idea is expressed in the pradakshina path? 1

(a) competition **(b)** trade
(c) reverence by circling the sacred **(d)** war

3. Which evidence shows that ordinary people supported stupas? 1

(a) donors' names carved on railings **(b)** royal seals
(c) ships **(d)** farm tools

4. Which would an archaeologist use to date a temple? 1

(a) weather **(b)** roads
(c) inscriptions and style **(d)** colours

5. Why is conservation of old monuments difficult? 1

(a) too cheap **(b)** too small
(c) too new **(d)** weather, pollution and encroachment

6. Why do temple complexes have both a mandapa and garbhagriha? 1

(a) one is for storing grain and the other for cooking
(b) one is for gathering and the other for the deity
(c) one is for defence and the other for trade
(d) one is a tank and the other a gateway

7. Why are cenotaphs not considered tombs? 1

(a) the person is not buried there **(b)** they are old
(c) they are small **(d)** they are tall

8. Which comparison is correct? 1

(a) Stupas house deities, temples hold relics
(b) Stupas hold relics, temples house deities
(c) Both are tombs
(d) Both are forts

9. **Assertion (A):** The garbhagriha is the innermost sanctum of a temple. 1
Reason (R): The garbhagriha is the prayer hall of a mosque facing Mecca.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Kailasha Temple at Ellora was built by stacking blocks of stone one over another. 1
Reason (R): It was carved from a single mass of rock.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why do monuments need maintenance? 2

12. Why did Persian ideas enter Mughal architecture? 2

13. Why did Rajput forts use water tanks within the walls? 2

14. Why is the Indo-Saracenic style controversial? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the importance of patronage in the building of monuments. 3

16. Examine the idea behind the temple plan as the cosmic man. 3

17. Analyse the significance of Indo-Saracenic buildings for the colonial state. 3

OR

Compare the use of space in a stupa and a temple. 3

18. Analyse how Mughal architecture blended Persian and Indian elements. 3

OR

Evaluate how architecture reflects religious pluralism in India. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** The Sanchi Stupa is a dome-shaped structure that holds relics of the Buddha or revered monks. Its four decorated gateways, the toranas, are carved with scenes from the Jataka stories. In early Buddhist art the Buddha himself was not shown in human form; footprints and the wheel stood for his presence. 5
(i) What does a stupa hold?
(ii) What are the decorated gateways called?
(iii) How was the Buddha shown in early Buddhist art?
(iv) How do the carvings on toranas help historians?

20. Discuss the role of water in Indian architecture using stepwells, tanks and forts. 5

OR

Examine the role of patrons and communities in building monuments. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks